Lessons from earlier runs

- A function that sorted or edited its input in place failed the "input not changed" test twice. Copy the input first, for example with sorted() or a list copy.
- Intervals that touch, such as [1, 2] and [2, 3], must merge. Intervals with a gap, such as [0, 2] and [3, 6], must not merge.
- A self-written test once expected a wrong merge result. Check expected values by hand before trusting them.
- Test files that use pytest decorators without importing pytest crash before any test runs. Use plain asserts inside test_ functions.
- Top-level assert statements outside a test function crash during collection. Put them inside functions.